

Empathy Map

The Empathy Map captures the thoughts, feelings, and behaviours of our primary user – the smallholder farmer – to ensure OptiCrop is designed around real human needs.

Primary User Persona

Name	Ravi Kumar
Age	42 years
Location	Nashik district, Maharashtra, India
Education	Class 10 (Secondary School Certificate)
Farm size	2.5 acres rain-fed, mixed soil
Languages	Marathi (primary), basic Hindi
Tech access	Budget smartphone, 3G internet in village, no laptop

SAYS

- "I planted tomatoes last year because my neighbour did – but prices crashed and I lost money."
- "If someone could just tell me what to plant, I'd do it."
- "Soil testing costs ₹500 and the lab is 30 km away – I can't afford the time or money."

THINKS

- "Am I making the right crop choice? What if rainfall is low this year?"
- "The fertilizer dealer recommends products that make him money, not what's best for me."
- "If this tool is wrong, I lose my entire season's income."

DOES

- "Asks neighbours and local traders for informal crop advice"
- "Observes soil colour, texture, and past crop performance as soil health proxy"
- "Checks government weather SMS alerts for weekly forecasts"
- "Attends the district Krishi Mela (agricultural fair) once a year"

FEELS

- "Anxious before each planting season – high stakes with little information"
- "Hopeful when he hears about new agricultural technologies"
- "Proud of his land and motivated to improve yields for his family"

PAINS

- " No access to soil-testing services without significant travel and cost
- " Information overload from contradictory advice (neighbours, dealers, TV, SMS)
- " Seasonal debt cycles when crops underperform

GAINS

- " A single, trusted recommendation he can act on with confidence
- " Simple interface requiring minimal data entry (7 numeric inputs)
- " Increased income and food security through data-driven crop selection

Design Implications for OptiCrop

Based on the empathy map, OptiCrop must prioritise: (1) extreme simplicity in the input form, (2) unambiguous recommendation display, (3) mobile-first responsive design, (4) fast page load on 3G networks, and (5) a trustworthy, non-technical explanation of the recommendation.